

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Engineer | Detection Engineering | Microsoft Sentinel | CrowdStrike Falcon

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience designing and delivering high-quality security detections across enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms. I specialise in building advanced detection logic and automation using Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) and have strong applied knowledge of Splunk's Search Processing Language (SPL). I am expert-level in CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and experienced with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), conducting structured Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)-focused threat hunting aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. My background spans detection engineering, incident response, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation, and complex query development across large-scale enterprise environments. I am eligible to undergo Security Check (SC) clearance and bring a disciplined, engineering-led mindset to maturing Security Operations Centre (SOC) capabilities for government and defence-adjacent programmes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)) - advanced detection rule creation, threat detection logic, automation playbooks; Splunk (Search Processing Language (SPL)) - query development, dashboard creation, alert building
- **EDR / Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, and Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) - expert-level administration and threat hunting; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) - deep integration with Microsoft Sentinel for XDR-aligned threat hunting
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end incident lifecycle management aligned to NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK-mapped investigation, containment, eradication, and post-incident review
- **Detection Logic and Automation:** Complex KQL analytics rules, scheduled alert queries, SOAR playbook automation, logic app integrations within Microsoft Sentinel; Splunk SPL correlation searches, saved searches, and dashboard panels
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus - continuous control validation and vulnerability remediation oversight
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), cloud-native security posture alignment
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Additional Tools:** BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mimecast, Tanium, Check Point Harmony, PowerShell scripting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Design and deliver high-quality security detections across Microsoft Sentinel using advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL), building complex analytics rules, scheduled alert queries, and hunting queries to identify threats across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud data sources.
- Engineer advanced detection logic within Microsoft Sentinel, creating automation playbooks via Logic Apps and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) integrations to accelerate alert triage and reduce analyst workload for high-volume, low-fidelity alerts.
- Conduct Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)-focused threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, systematically searching for adversarial Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework across an 8,000-user enterprise environment.

- Perform structured threat hunting using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) in conjunction with Microsoft Sentinel, leveraging advanced hunting queries to surface lateral movement, credential theft, and persistence techniques.
- Develop and maintain Splunk searches, dashboards, and correlation rules to support Security Operations Centre (SOC) visibility requirements and integrate telemetry from network, endpoint, and cloud sources.
- Lead incident response activities from detection through to post-incident review, applying NIST 800-61 methodology and MITRE ATT&CK-aligned investigation techniques to contain and eradicate threats.
- Continuously tune and refine detection coverage by analysing false positive rates, incorporating threat intelligence feeds, and benchmarking detection logic against MITRE ATT&CK framework coverage gaps.
- Oversee vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), using BAS results to validate detection efficacy and identify gaps in SIEM and EDR alerting.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Prevent, and Discover modules, managing platform configuration, policy optimisation, and integration with downstream SOAR and ticketing workflows.
- Maintain Security Operations Centre (SOC) operational documentation, detection runbooks, and playbooks, ensuring consistent, repeatable response procedures for the security team.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Built and maintained detection rules and alert logic within Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, progressively maturing the institution's detection engineering capability from reactive alert response to proactive, threat-intelligence-informed detection.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the enterprise endpoint estate, performing structured threat hunting, alert triage, and incident investigation using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover modules.
- Developed Splunk Search Processing Language (SPL) queries to support SOC visibility, producing searches, dashboards, and scheduled reports for security operations and management stakeholders.
- Conducted structured threat hunting campaigns aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying previously undetected threats and converting findings into permanent detection rules within Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM.
- Supported full incident response lifecycle activities, performing digital forensics triage on affected endpoints using CrowdStrike Falcon and MDE tooling, and driving containment, eradication, and recovery steps.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) controls, and administered Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to detect and respond to identity-based attack patterns.
- Supported vulnerability scanning programmes using Tenable.io and Nessus, using findings to inform detection engineering priorities and improve coverage of known exploitation patterns.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered security engineering support across a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, managing security tooling, endpoint protection, and identity access controls.
- Supported security monitoring operations including log review, alert triage, and escalation of security events, building foundational SIEM and incident response skills in a production environment.
- Conducted internal vulnerability assessments, tracked remediation activities, and contributed to penetration test preparation, developing a structured approach to vulnerability lifecycle management.
- Supported the configuration of email security gateway controls and endpoint security tooling, contributing to the organisation's security operations and compliance posture.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered a comprehensive library of Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules and SOAR automation playbooks, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-fidelity security alerts and significantly improving SOC throughput.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon across the full 8,000-user enterprise estate, achieving near-complete EDR coverage and establishing the platform as the organisation's primary threat hunting and endpoint telemetry source.

- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate detection and response controls, using automated adversary simulation to identify and close detection gaps within Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM.
- Led MITRE ATT&CK-aligned threat hunting campaigns that identified previously undetected adversarial activity, converting hunt findings into permanent detection logic across both Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000+ users, integrating both platforms with Microsoft Sentinel to establish a unified Extended Detection and Response (XDR) capability for the organisation.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)